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Faculty of Economic, Commercial and Management Sciences
First Year – Common Core
Subject: English 1

Unit 3: Business discipline

A- Business Organizations

Location is very important for a business and can have a big effect on a company's success. Employers have to consider where to place their organization to make sure that they can compete with other businesses in the industry. They have to think about the costs of setting up a business, and also how much it will cost them in the future. Employees have higher salaries in some places than others. For example, in the UK, a firm will have to pay employees a higher salary in London than for the same job outside the capital. Professionals, such as teachers, medical staff or lawyers, are paid more to have a career in the city instead of studying there and then moving away. Any business that wants to be based in the city needs to have money in place to fund this choice.

1. Read text. Mark the statements true (T) or false (F) according to the text.

1. The location of a business does affect its success.
2. Businesses pay staff members the same amount in salary in different locations.
3. For employers, the cost of staff is more than the cost of supplies.
4. A business that manufactures things needs to plan where to source its materials.
5. The city is a secure location for all businesses.

Term	Definition According to the Note	Key Concept
Business	A company or firm that makes transactions or that runs one by which trade in goods or services.	General term for trade/transactions.
Company	A business organization that creates independently trade in goods and services.	An independent business organization.
Trade	The general word for workplaces with other workers or staff.	The act or location of employment.
Industry	The main types of trade in the goods and service sector are the secondary and tertiary sectors.	The sector/field of business activity (e.g., tech industry).
Finance	The word finance has a special meaning: P&L.	Financial tracking (Profit & Loss).
Firm	A company which provides a particular product or service.	Focuses on providing a specific product or expertise.

Usage note talking about businesses

Business, company and firm all describe organizations that make money by selling goods or services.

A company is a business organization that exists independently of its owners and employees:

- Walmart is one of the world's largest companies, with shops in most countries.

Business often refers to a small company that is owned by an individual or a family:

- The family business has operated since 1985.

Firm means a company that provides a particular professional service:

- The accountancy firm employs 35 people.

An industry describes all the people and activities involved in producing a particular thing or providing a particular service: the automobile/manufacturing/chemical industry

2 Complete the sets of sentences using the correct form of the words provided.

1 - employee – employer – professional

a. As more people become self-employed, there is a growth in businesses with just one _____.
b. b Graduate job fairs at universities help _____ find future staff.
c. c Employing a marketing _____ helps a business grow as they focus on ways to sell products.

2 - job – career

a. She's worked for several different companies throughout her _____ as an accountant.
b. b As the economy slowed down, around 25% of graduates could not find a _____.

3 organization – industry

a. Sales in the car _____ have fallen by more than 10% since 2008.
b. b Many international _____ have moved their businesses to areas where staff costs are lower.

B- Customers and products

In recent times, consumer choice has increased due to the growth of global markets and the internet. Greater access to information on products and services has given consumers greater choice. It has also given them greater power. A business which wants commercial success has

to focus on the needs of customers and their experiences when they purchase goods. They have to be able to guarantee quality goods and service. Consequently, marketing has become an industry which has greater importance to modern businesses.

3. Read text. Do the paragraphs have roughly the same meaning as the original text (S) or do they have a different meaning (D)?

1 '... **consumer** choice has increased due to the growth of global markets and the internet.'

- Globalization and online shopping mean that people can buy things cheaper than before. ___

2 'Greater access to information on **products** and **services** has given consumers greater choice.'

- People are in a better position because they can find out more about what they want to buy. ___

Usage Note: Customer and Consumer

Term	Definition	Key Relationship	Example
Customer	The person who **buys** a product or a service from a business (the one who handles the transaction).	Buyer Business	A supermarket **customer**
Consumer	The person who **uses** a product or a service (the final user).	User Product	The **consumer** of microchips or electron

4. Complete each description with a word from the box.

(consumer, customer, guarantee, product, purchase, service)

1. Sony's new smartphone is one of the most popular on the market. It is a bestselling _____.
2. Assil is eight years old. He wants his parents to buy an Xbox for his next birthday. He is a _____.
3. The Anderson Company offer advice on how to do business in Asia. This is their _____.
4. He bought the latest game on the day it was released. He's a repeat _____ at the store.
5. The factory buys large amounts of electricity to use when producing goods. They _____ more than their competitors.
6. The company promises to keep prices low. They _____ it.

5 Match the sentence halves

1. Large websites such as Amazon have increased **consumer** 2. Customers often use the internet to compare **product** 3. By increasing their focus on **customer** 4. Having a good reputation plays an important role in **commercial** 5. The company's promise to its customers **guarantees**	a. **success**, as companies which are trusted tend to have more repeat customers. b. **needs**, their business became more competitive. c. **choice**, but have had a negative effect on small businesses. d. **information** before making an offline purchase. e. **quality** at low prices.

6. Writing Task

Write a short paragraph (three or four sentences) about one of the following. Try to use some of the words and phrases from the unit.

- Describe a business that has been successful in recent years.
- Describe a business you know well.

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Words to learn		
• unit (n) • company (n) • commercial (adj) • consumer (n) • customer (n) • staff (n	• firm (n) • industry (n) • employee (n) • employer (n) • finance (n) • professional (n, adj)	• product (n) • service (n) • success (n) • guarantee (n) • location (n) • purchase (n, v) • set up (phrasal v)